

Product Development Process

Statement of Purpose

As licensor, Cookie Jar is responsible for setting and maintaining the standards for our brands.

In order to ensure that all branded merchandise and marketing materials meet these standards, licensees must adhere to the procedures and policies outlined as follows.

Product

The licensee shall submit all **KEY** phases of product development for review by Cookie Jar Consumer Products.

What are key phases?

1. Product Concept

2. Design Phases, A,B,C…(varies according to product category)

3. Pre-Production

4. Final Production

Each phase is reviewed separately and subject to comments, changes and/or resubmission as deemed necessary and in as many steps as necessary.

Licensees may proceed to the next phase of development **only** when approved in writing by Cookie Jar.

Please allow up to 10 business days for review from the receipt of your submission.

Product Concept

The product development process begins with your submission of a clearly defined **product concept**, a visual representation/art layout of the intended design accompanied by written explanation (on the product submission form provided) to convey a full understanding of the product.

Things important to communicate in this submission:

- The basics: size, shape, color, materials, etc...
- Your company's own product ID number for the SKU
- Intended audience
- Complete line plans
- Known production limitations
- 3D layouts for sculpts with color callout
- Special features

Product Concept

Cookie Jar Submission Approval Number

Submission approval numbers will be assigned to all initial concepts and will be clearly stated on the approval form when returned – please also include your company's own internal product identification number with each submission for cross-referencing purposes. Each project will have one submission number even though there may be more than one component. This number must be clearly stated at each stage following the initial concept. Please be aware that subsequent submissions will not be processed without the Cookie Jar submission approval number listed. Absence of this number may delay approval time.

Design Phases

Depending upon the product category, there may be one **design phase** submission or many. Outlined below are typical steps. Your product design phases may vary and should be tailored to your specific product development process.

A. 1st design phase

- For printed items this first step would be a graphic layout (parts or whole).
- For apparel items this would be swatches, notions, strike-offs or a hand-sample (parts or whole).
- For sculpted items it would be a rough sculpt (parts or whole).
- May also be parts of a whole for more complicated products i.e., hair samples, eyes or voice recording for dolls, interactive, electronics, etc.

B. 2nd design phase

- For printed items this would be a final color layout of all components with:
  1. Indicated template
  2. correct scale
  3. legal copy
  4. Color call outs
- For apparel items this would be a sewn/hand sample
- For sculpted items this would be a paint master

C. Continued design phases as necessary…

Pre-Production

The **Pre-Production** submission should be a complete working and quality sample of your product with all it's parts and legal markings, etc. This submission should not be packaged.

As pre-production is often the first time a product is seen in its entirety, Cookie Jar reserves the right to request changes through this phase of development.

Please send a digital color photo file, front and back, and all legal markings (sides if applicable), of the submission when the pre-production is sent.

Final Production

The last phase of product development is submission of **Final Production samples**.

A product is not closed out of our system until production samples have been received and approved in writing by Cookie Jar. Please supply your contractually required amount of fully completed and packaged production samples before or at the time of your first shipment to retailers. Any quality issues or production errors will be noted by Cookie Jar and will require running changes in the next production run.

Packaging

Packaging layouts must be submitted to Cookie Jar on a parallel path with product in as many submissions as necessary until the layout is approved for production. New licensees will be required to submit proofs for individual packaging types to ensure quality and color correctness.

Packaging layouts should be submitted full scale and include:

1. All panels including copy
2. Indicated die-lines
3. Color call outs
4. Placement of product
5. Product photography
6. Inserts
7. Legal notices and logos

Stickers or typeset changes shall be submitted separately.

Marketing Materials

It is important that all marketing materials meet the same standards as product and packaging. Therefore, the same submission process applies to these items. Examples of marketing materials:

- Sell Sheets
- Promotions
- Collateral items
- Trade Show Displays & Signage
- Advertisements (trade or consumer)
- Press Releases*

Similar to product, marketing materials should be submitted to Cookie Jar in key phases of development:

1. Concept - a visual and/or written explanation of marketing plans i.e., outline of promotion, storyboard of TV advertisement, sketch or rough layout of printed pieces. Include information on purpose and intended target, as necessary.

2. Design Phases(s) - full layouts for printed pieces or appropriate phases of development for other items.

3. Pre-production - as necessary for items other than printed pieces

4. Final Production - samples of fully printed or produced items for Cookie Jar files

Steps 1-3 must be submitted to Cookie Jar for review as many times as necessary, until approved to move to the next phase.

**** No licensee shall release any information regarding their business with Cookie Jar or the named brand without first being reviewed and approved by Cookie Jar. Press releases should be submitted (with sufficient notice) to your category manager, complete with information regarding intended publication(s) and date of release.***

Submission Procedures

1. All submissions must be sent with a completed Cookie Jar Product Submission Form. Incomplete forms or missing forms will require resubmission before product is reviewed.

2. Your company will be granted access to our FTP site upon execution of your licensing agreement. **Please upload ALL submission forms, concept art, digital photos of pre-production samples, etc. into the "To Cookie Jar" folder in your FTP folder and notify the product development assistant** (and please copy your PD contact on the email).

3. Pre-production samples will not be returned unless noted on the submission form. Please list the account number of the preferred shipping service your company uses and we will return samples via Ground for Domestic and Economy for International unless specified otherwise.

4. Please send all samples (pre-production and final) to the attention of the appropriate category manager at the address listed below:

The Cookie Jar Company
Attn: (your PD contact)
4100 West Alameda Ave., 4th Floor
Burbank, CA 91505

Submission Comments

Each Submission will be returned with comments and instructions on how to proceed:

- **Approved / Approved with Changes**: you are approved to move on to the next noted step in the development process. If changes are requested, these changes MUST be incorporated into the next development step and/or submission.

- **Resubmit**: you must resubmit this same submission again, incorporating all requested changes, before moving on to the next phase of development.

- **Not Approved**: submission is not acceptable as is or is not within the licensed articles listed within your agreement and it will not be approved for continued development.

Submission Comments continued

Comments are returned to licensee only after our records have been updated and the submission(s) has been logged out of our system. Times may vary depending on current work load.

The standard turn around time for each submission is 10 business days from receipt. While we do everything possible to return things faster, ***you should allow for the full 10 business days in your product development timeline***.

Comments will be returned via email/FTP (or standard mail where applicable).

Special Requests

From time to time we understand the need for RUSH service. If we can accommodate you, we will do so. In order to request RUSH service please make arrangements with your product development contact in advance either by phone or email.

You may also have need for additional art files, transparencies or other items. Please direct all such requests to your product development contact via phone or e-mail. All style guides and available additional poses can be found on Mediabox. The product development assistant will make arrangements to grant your company access to Mediabox.

Phone (818) 955-5400

Fax (818) 955-5409

Partnership/Expertise

We look at the licensor/licensee relationship as a partnership. We understand that you, the licensee, are the experts in your category and expect that you will take the lead in developing product that is fitting for the brand and relevant to the market place. Please remember we at Cookie Jar are the experts in our brands with knowledge of your category as well. Given this, we review things on two levels:

1. In the scope of the brand as a whole

2. As individual products

All comments and requested changes are made in the spirit of producing the best branded product possible. A dialogue is welcome if your expertise is at odds with any of our comments. Please contact your product development point person should the need arise.